Order and Chaos

2015—UPSC Bhavan, New Delhi.

The air in the interview room was hushed, thick with the scent of polished wood and anticipation. It was still, like the pregnant pause before a monsoon storm, where the clouds held their breath, waiting to burst

Krishna sat in the hot seat, his posture composed, spine straight, palms resting calmly on his thighs, neither clenched nor fidgeting. The faint hum of the AC was the only sound, a subtle counterpoint to Krishna's own steady heartbeat.

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Across the table sat five members of the **Union Public Service Commission (UPSC)**, their expressions carefully neutral, yet keenly observant.

To the far left, a woman in her fifties with sharp eyes and salt-and-pepper hair had his Detailed Application Form (DAF) already open, her gaze flicking with practiced speed between the pages and his face.

Next to her, a man with fingers steepled thoughtfully, regarded him with a calculating gaze that seemed to map out his motivations, searching for any chinks in his carefully constructed armour.

The rightmost panellist, a lean man with restless eyes, tapped a silver pen, drumming it rhythmically against a notepad. His gaze was a silent challenge, testing Krishna's composure without a single word.

Beside him, a man in his early 40s, his posture ramrod straight, observed with strict, unwavering composure.

In the middle, the chairman, a man in his sixties with a measured voice and eyes crinkling slightly at the corners, finally broke the silence.

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"Mr. Krishna," he began, his tone calm yet firm, "You could've chosen the Indian Administrative Service—the most sought-after post. Yet you've opted for the Indian Police Service. Why?"

Krishna had anticipated this question. Though he'd rehearsed his answers countless times in front of mirrors and mentors, in this defining moment, the words now came to him with an unforced clarity.

He looked the chairman in the eye, his voice calm and assured. "Sir, policy-making and administration are the backbone of governance. But security and vigilance are the shield that protects that backbone. Without law and order, even the most visionary policies fail to reach the people they're meant to serve."

A faint, almost imperceptible nod from the pen-tapping panellist was a flicker of silent acknowledgment that Krishna spoke his truth.

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The woman panellist with an air of quiet authority leaned forward. "You believe law and order take precedence over policy?"

Krishna didn't blink. "Ma'am, I believe they are interdependent. But in today's context, vigilance has

become more urgent. We live in an age where threats are not always visible."

He paused briefly. "The battlefield has moved online, and the weapons are no longer guns—they're lines of code, stolen data, psychological manipulation."

He allowed his words to resonate before continuing with added conviction.

"Sir, I've seen people close to me fall victim to online scams. I've seen families broken—not by bullets, but by silence and shame. The quiet devastation of trust shattered, hopes stolen in the dark."

He paused, the memory of those broken families fuelling his resolve, before adding, "According to the National Crime Records Bureau, financial crimes are rising at nearly 25% annually. Investment scams, chit fund frauds, and online thefts have devastated families."

Krishna leaned forward, voice quiet but firm. "Organized crime has adapted, thriving in digital anonymity. Criminals no longer require masks or getaway vehicles; an internet connection *is* all they need."

As the stark numbers settled in the air, Krishna leaned slightly forward, his voice imbued with quiet conviction.

“Policy-making sets the framework. But without enforcement, those guidelines remain mere words on paper. I want to ensure that the laws we create are not just abstract concepts, but a living force that protects people in both the real and digital worlds.”

The chairman’s crinkled eyes softened for a moment, hinting at approval beneath his composed exterior.

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The man in his early 40s, who had been observing with strict composure, now spoke, his voice crisp.

"Mr. Krishna, you mentioned the rising crime rate, especially cybercrime. In your opinion, why has this surge occurred?"

Krishna met his gaze directly.

"Sir, I believe it's largely due to a policy gap. Policies are often formulated at the top level with the best intentions, but as they filter down, gaps in execution and understanding emerge, creating loopholes that criminals exploit. In this transition, gaps inevitably emerge in every policy. These aren't always glaring flaws, but subtle discrepancies in their understanding and application on the ground.”

Krishna sipped the water, gathering his thoughts before continuing. “These gaps create an environment of public unrest and frustration, which can manifest in various forms, including an increase in certain types of criminal activity, as people feel unheard or unprotected."

The man with fingers steepled thoughtfully, asked, "And you believe the Indian Police Service is the best platform?"

Krishna nodded without hesitation.

"More than a platform, sir. It’s a responsibility. One I’m ready for."

The room was silent again—this time not still, but thoughtful.

The chairman, resting his chin on his hand, studied him for a long moment. Then, with a faint smile that finally reached his eyes, he gently closed the file in front of him, the soft thud a definitive punctuation mark.

“Thank you, Mr. Krishna.”

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As Krishna rose, offering a crisp nod, his gaze held steady on the chairman's face. In that moment, a profound understanding bloomed within him.

This was more than the end of an interview—it was the beginning of a war. Not fought with weapons, but a battle between order and chaos.

And Krishna was ready to fight.

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